

Daniel Rodriguez

iOS Engineer · Game Developer

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SUMMARY

Senior iOS engineer with 13+ years of full-time iOS experience and a 16-year career across mobile and games. Architecturally-minded IC who has shipped consumer apps as the sole iOS engineer at multiple roles, most recently a hybrid WKWebView + native SwiftUI app as Founding iOS Engineer at Adapter Group, pioneering an AI-native development workflow with Claude Code. Earlier work includes a BAFTA-winning title at FreshPlanet and AR pipeline and features at Warby Parker. Expertise in Swift, SwiftUI, and Swift Concurrency. Continuing to ship indie apps to the App Store. Bilingual (English / Spanish).

EXPERIENCE

Founding iOS Engineer

Adapter Group — New York, NY · December 2024 – March 2026

- Sole iOS engineer on a hybrid WKWebView + native SwiftUI consumer app, taking the product from zero to App Store in under a year.
- Designed and built a type-safe TypeScript ↔ Swift bridge for two-way communication between the web layer and native iOS code.
- Architected the iOS app's foundation: Auth0 authentication with universal link handling, deep linking, push notifications, and a custom SwiftUI component library with Rive-powered animations.
- Built a real-time AI assistant interface using SSE-powered streaming, REST API integration, and Swift Concurrency (async/await).
- Stood up the team's CI/CD pipeline, App Store Connect submission process, and TestFlight distribution from scratch — initially on Xcode Cloud, then migrated to GitHub Actions to reduce build times and eliminate a recurring monthly cost.
- Pioneered an AI-native development workflow (Claude Code, Warp.dev, Git worktrees for multi-agent feature work), demonstrating that a single engineer could deliver a production-grade consumer app at startup pace.

Indie Apps & Engines (Shipped)

Independent — New York, NY · 2020 – Present

- **KiteCalc** (2026, Ongoing) — Solo-shipped an iOS app for kiteboarding gear calculations, available on the App Store. Built in Swift/SwiftUI for iOS 26. Calculation engine open-sourced at github.com/dornad/KiteboardingKit
- **Repe.app** (2026) — Collectible sticker album web game engine. SvelteKit, TypeScript, Vercel. 135+ users. IP-agnostic engine with runtime content switching, lz-string collection sync, and feature flag system.
- **Global Game Jam** — Unbroken annual streak since 2019. Eight games shipped from scratch in 48-hour sessions using Godot and Unity.

Senior Software Engineer — iOS & AR

Warby Parker — New York, NY · July 2021 – October 2024

- Shipped iOS features for Warby Parker's consumer app, featured by Apple on the App Store.
- Led the architectural redesign of the consumer app's AR experiences during the SceneKit → RealityKit migration: virtual glasses try-on with face tracking, glasses removal, and branded Easter eggs (including a Spider-Man 2 PS5 launch tie-in).
- Extracted the AR/3D feature into a standalone Swift framework, enabling reuse across multiple internal and consumer surfaces.
- Built an internal iPadOS tool consuming that framework, letting the design team load GLTF 3D models from Files or Google Drive and preview them directly in the AR experience — bypassing the existing asset pipeline entirely. Shipped and adopted as the standard internal preview tool.
- Built a separate internal iPadOS measurements app from scratch using Apple Vision frameworks, deployed across all Warby Parker retail locations nationwide.

Senior Software Engineer — iOS

Paperless Post — New York, NY · July 2015 – June 2020

- Core iOS engineer for 5 years, owning development and maintenance of the consumer app through the full Objective-C to Swift transition.
- Led yearly adoption of new Apple platform features, keeping the app competitive at each iOS launch.
- Mentored a team of 5–10 mobile engineers, guiding best practices and code quality across the platform.

EARLY CAREER

Lead Mobile Game Engineer — HOMER Learning (2014–2015)

Sole mobile engineer (reporting to CTO) on an iPad game teaching children to read. Shipped features on monthly release cycles.

Lead Software Engineer — AnyoneGame / Just Sing It (2013–2014)

Sole engineer for a social karaoke app with 200K+ users. Took two apps from concept to App Store — marking the pivot from game development into iOS engineering.

Technical Lead & Game Programmer — FreshPlanet / Gameloft (2010–2013)

Shipped multiple social and mobile games on Facebook Canvas, iOS, and Android. Built Adobe AIR Native Extensions in Objective-C and Java.

Software Engineer / Assistant Professor — Carnegie Mellon University (2010)

Built a no-code AR exhibit creation tool for museum staff. Co-taught Building Virtual Worlds; advised undergraduate thesis via semester exchange with Universidad de Monterrey.

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University

Master of Entertainment Technology · 2008 – 2009

Entertainment Technology Center (ETC) — interdisciplinary program for game design, interactive media, and entertainment technology. Alumni include game developers at Naughty Dog, Pixar, and EA.

Sketch-It-Up! — Publication: Bulut Karakaya, Camilo Garcia, Daniel Rodriguez, Manoj Nityanandam, Nadia Labeikovsky and Theyab Al-Tamimi. "Sketch-It-Up! Demo", *Lecture Notes in Computer Science: Entertainment Computing – ICEC 2009 (2009): 313–14.*

Universidad de los Andes — Bogotá, Colombia

B.Sc., Computer and Software Engineering · 2000 – 2006 · Focus: Real-time computer graphics

SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Languages: Swift · Objective-C · TypeScript · Python · GDScript

iOS Frameworks: SwiftUI · UIKit · Combine · Swift Concurrency (async/await) · WebKit / WKWebView · ARKit · RealityKit · SceneKit · TCA · Point Free Dependencies · XCTest · Swift Testing

Mobile Engineering: Push Notifications · Universal Links · Deep Linking · Auth0 / OAuth · MVVM · TestFlight · App Store Connect · REST APIs · SSE · Feature Flags (PostHog, OpenFeature, ConfigCat)

Tooling & CI/CD: Xcode · Xcode Cloud · GitHub Actions · Git · Zed · VSCode · Claude Code · OpenCode · Warp.dev

Game Engines: Godot · Unity

Spoken Languages: English (native) · Spanish (native / bilingual)